

Hiring Assignment

AI + Influencer Marketing

What this is about

We're hiring someone who will own the intersection of influencer marketing and AI at our agency. Not someone who talks about AI in meetings. Someone who can look at how a 40-person influencer team works today, find the bottlenecks, and build systems that make the team 3x faster without 3x the people.

This assignment is designed to see how you think under real constraints, how you handle messy data, and whether you can actually build something that works — not just describe it.

The Brief

A mid-size D2C skincare brand is launching a new serum line. They want to run an influencer campaign across Instagram and YouTube. Here are the constraints:

- Budget: ₹15 lakhs for influencer fees (all-inclusive)
- Timeline: 3 weeks from shortlisting to post-campaign report
- They want a mix of macro, micro, and nano influencers
- Strict competitor exclusivity: no influencer who has posted for Minimalist, mCaffeine, or Mamaearth in the last 90 days
- All content must go through 2 rounds of brand approval before posting
- The brand wants at least 40% of influencers from Tier 2/3 cities
- Deliverables: 1 Reel per influencer (Instagram), 1 dedicated video per influencer (YouTube)

Attached: A spreadsheet with 50 influencer profiles. This is your raw data. It's messy on purpose — some data is missing, some influencers have red flags, some have competitor conflicts. This is what real data looks like.

Part 1 - Shortlist from the Data

Time estimate: 45–60 minutes

Using the attached influencer database, build a shortlist that fits the brief. Your shortlist should stay within the ₹15L budget and meet all the constraints above.

For each influencer you select, briefly note why they made the cut. For any you explicitly rejected, note why. Flag any profiles where the data made you suspicious and explain what you'd verify before signing them.

What we're evaluating: Can you make real decisions with imperfect data? Do you catch the traps in the sheet — the inflated followers, the competitor conflicts, the missing rates? Can you build a list that actually fits a budget?

Part 2 - Map the Workflow + Find the AI Opportunities

Now map the end-to-end campaign workflow — from the moment the brand sends you this brief to the final performance report. Every step the team would execute.

For each step, mark it as one of:

1. **Fully automatable with AI** — no human needed
2. **AI-assisted** — AI does the heavy lifting, human reviews/approves
3. **Human-only** — and explain why AI can't or shouldn't do this

Don't just say "AI can help with outreach." Specify: what model or tool, what's the input, what's the output, what does the human check before it goes out?

The Curveballs

Your workflow should also account for these mid-campaign situations. For each one, explain how your system handles it and where AI plays a role:

- Week 2: You discover that 4 influencers from your shortlist posted competitor content (Minimalist) in the last 10 days — after you'd already signed them. What happens?
- Week 2: 3 influencers go silent after accepting the brief. No content submitted, no response to messages. What's your contingency, and could AI have predicted this risk earlier?

- Week 3: The brand rejects 40% of first-draft content for “not matching brand tone.” How do you prevent this from happening in the first place?

What we’re evaluating: Do you think in systems that handle failure, not just happy paths? Do you have genuine judgment about where AI adds value versus where it’s a gimmick?

Part 3 - Build a Working Tool

Build a working influencer shortlisting tool. It should take the attached spreadsheet (or similar data) as input and produce a ranked, scored shortlist as output — with clear reasoning for each selection.

This can be anything: a prompt chain in ChatGPT/Claude, a Google Sheet with scoring logic, a Python script, a Notion workflow, an n8n automation, a simple web app. We don’t care what you use. We care that it works.

Your tool should handle at minimum:

- Scoring influencers against brand fit (engagement, audience relevance, content quality)
- Flagging competitor conflicts and data red flags automatically
- Fitting the selection within a given budget
- Explaining why each influencer was selected or rejected

What we’re evaluating: Did you build something that actually works, or did you write a description of something that could theoretically work? There’s a big difference.

Part 4 - Sell It Internally

Time estimate: 20–30 minutes

Record a 2–3 minute Loom video (or write a one-page note) explaining your Part 3 tool to a non-technical business head who runs the influencer team. Assume this person is skeptical about AI and worried about job displacement.

Your pitch should cover: what does the tool do, how much time does it save, what does the team still own, and why should they trust this over their existing process?

What we’re evaluating: Can you sell AI to a skeptical room? This is literally the job. The best tool in the world is useless if the team won’t adopt it.

Guidelines

- **Total time:** 3–4 hours across all four parts. If you're spending 6+ hours, you're overbuilding.
- **Format:** Submit however you want — doc, slides, Notion page, live link, screen recording. No restrictions on format.
- **AI usage:** You should use AI tools while working on this. Tell us which ones and how. Candidates who use AI well score higher than those who don't use it at all.
- **Deadline:** 48 hours from when you receive this.
- **Attached file:** influencer_database.xlsx — this is your raw data for Parts 1 and 3.